



Gaming Laptops

In terms of pure performance on a mobile computer, gaming laptops reign supreme (along with mobile workstations). They're as powerful as any mainstay desktop PC, earning themselves the title of "desktop replacements", besides being great for fragging.

Not much has changed with gaming laptops over the years. Today, all manufacturers boast Intel-based chipsets with high-end quad-core processors (eg: the latest Sandy Bridge Core i7 chips), while the laptop's accompanying graphics are sourced either from Nvidia or AMD – the GeForce 500M and Radeon HD 6000M series, respectively, currently doing the rounds.

For added graphics chops, Nvidia's SLI and AMD's CrossFireX are added. Some gaming laptops do support stereoscopic 3D displays for gaming in 3D, but apart from a few models launched this year, the trend isn't widely prevalent throughout the industry. Due to the larger frames of gaming laptops, 14 to 17-inch form factors manufacturers are trying to improve and fine-tune the end-user experience – for e.g., MSI's G series laptops has Dynaudio speakers onboard, possibly the best sound we've heard on any laptop till date.

The full gamut of connectivity ports is another plus. We've only seen Blu-ray ROMs in a select few made-to-order gaming laptop configurations, and we hope it becomes a de facto standard in gaming laptops very soon.

Zero1 Winner ASUS G74SX

The overall best performing gaming laptop of the year, and winner of the coveted Zero1 awards is the ASUS G74SX. The G74SX narrowly out-performed the Alienware M17x; the ASUS laptop sports a 17.3-inch full-HD widescreen display, an Intel Core i7-2630QM processor, 16 GB of RAM, 1TB hard drive and NVIDIA GeForce GTX560M graphics with 3GB dedicated memory. This monster machine easily handles the latest and greatest games without breaking a sweat – *Far Cry 2* at 1920x1080 and High settings ran at 46.1 FPS, while *DiRT 3* at 1920x1080 and maximum settings ran at 22.6 FPS, very good for the laptop's hardware. A great buy if you can shell out the ₹1.2-lakh premium it demands.

Worthy Mentions Alienware M17x

While we speak highly of the Asus G74SX, we'd also like to mention the Alienware M17x which gave the ASUS



Asus G74SX
Price: ₹1,20,000



Lightest gaming laptop

If you want the lightest gaming laptop out there, just go for the Alienware M11x. It has a compact 11-inch form factor and weighs around 2 kgs, but has the right hardware to pack a performance punch.



Razer Blade

It's the company's flagship 17-inch gaming laptop, with 10 dynamic keys and an LCD screen to the right of the keyboard that supports multitouch input. Specs are in line with any modern gaming laptop capable of handling latest 3D games.



Alienware M17x
Price: ₹1,65,000



MSI GT680R
Price: ₹1,19,999

laptop a great run for its money. Apart from pure performance, the M17x's biggest draw is its iconic design and customisable glowing LED lights. Great buy for someone looking for a distinctive gaming laptop to show off at LAN parties.

MSI GT680R

Apart from high-performance, the GT680R gaming laptop from MSI has Dynaudio speakers, and with that comes one of the best audio experiences we've ever encountered on a laptop.

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